

BIOLUMINESCENCE

2025

I was employed as the Chief Architect of Sony PlayStation+²¹¹. I was told when I was hired that this role was experimental. There wasn't anyone in particular I was replacing. Therefore, it was largely on me to define this role within the organization.

One day, I was having a discussion with my manager about what the role of a chief architect is. Having performed admirably in this role at several other companies over the preceding couple of decades, I felt I was in a position to articulate the parameters of the role quite clearly. One of the major responsibilities of a chief architect is to work closely with Product Management to define the requirements for the subsequent release. I went on to explain how this is actual a very formal process and how vital it was to the success of Thermo Fisher's mass spectrometry product lines.

“Well, there isn't a product manager for PlayStation+ for you to meet with.”

This statement was true only in a very technical sense. While no one may have had the title “Product Manager” and been responsible for the totality of PlayStation+, there was certainly someone acting in that capacity... and it was

²¹¹ The game streaming service, not the console itself.

him!

“Furthermore, only a select group of people are privy to what is coming in the next PlayStation release and you are not among them.”

“But I’m your chief architect. I have to be!”

What do you think happened next? Did they realize the practical necessity of having me in the room and bringing in another chair?

Of course not.

Instead, they dissolved the position. Their logic being something along the lines of, “We never needed a chief architect before, we don’t need one now.”

After leaving Sony, I found myself in a very different job market. Artificial Intelligence (AI) had taken over. That part was fine. What got me was the Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS). Those completely reckless and irresponsible technical and moral failures cut me from every possible employment opportunity. Normally, I would receive at least an HR call for every application I would submit. This time around, I submitted over 300 applications with not one single call. I tried having AI redo my resume and customize it for every job I applied to and all of that. But there was no getting through the impenetrable wall of stupid.

So I focused on other ventures in the hope that I could generate income through other means. But I was a day late and a dollar short. So after over a year without income, I finally ran out of money. In most of America, that means that you are no longer valid as a human being and unworthy of human decency or compassion. The people you thought were your friends now eye you with suspicion. You quickly realize that capitalism itself is a pernicious and fatal disease of the soul.

But the good Lord's grace²¹² shone upon me: One friend, who I believed to be a fan of my work, offered to let me inhabit her spare bedroom while I got my other projects going. How kind of her, right? Well, perhaps it might have been. We'll never know for sure. Unfortunately, shortly after I moved in, her boyfriend also fell on hard times. So she tossed me out so that he could use the room.

After that, I was relegated to living in my car. That was an adjustment, but once I figured out the lay of the land, access to resources, and where to be at different times of the day, it wasn't so bad. I had a nice, big, luxury SUV with plenty of room for a self-inflating sleeping mat in the back, food, clothes, and my laptop. I even had a spare battery and a power inverter so I could power a pressure cooker and a small refrigerator. At night, I could camp at a state park where I had access to utility power, water connections, bathrooms with showers, and even sinks for washing dishes and clothing! It was definitely less convenient than having my own house, but I wasn't suffering.

I promise there's a point to all of this...

One fine day, I was driving through a hospital parking lot when I heard a loud sound coming from one of the rear speakers. The stereo was turned off! So I turned the car off and opened the back door to investigate. That's when I saw the flames...

I was able to save my bag of clothes and laptop. Everything else burned (my phone, money, debit cards, driver's license, tents, sleeping bag, sleeping mat, tools, food, etc... and, critically, my laptop power cord). And no, there was no insurance. Left to my own devices, facing freezing temperatures that night, it is unlikely that I would have survived.

The local police sergeant who responded to the fire realized my predicament and took me to a shelter called the "In the Streets, Hands Up High Ministry"²¹³

²¹² This is the Afterward. If you can't tell by now that I'm being sarcastic, I shudder to think of how you've interpreted the rest of the book.

²¹³ You can learn more about that organization in the Acknowledgments section at

headed by pastor Roland Nava. One fine day, I contracted the influenza virus and had to be hospitalized. Upon my return from the hospital, the godly pastor evicted me from the shelter. Why? Because illness is caused by demons, dontcha' know? He simply couldn't have a resident infested with demons putting all the other residents at risk²¹⁴.

So, there I was with my laptop²¹⁵ slung over one shoulder and my clothes over the other, walking in near-freezing temperatures, trying to recover from the flu, in a rural neighborhood with no particular destination in mind.

My top priority was getting a working phone again. I was close. I had acquired a phone, but it needed new a battery. I also managed to acquire a new battery for it; but it needed to be installed. So I was looking for somewhere I could sit and perform the battery replacement and hope that my old SIM card²¹⁶ would still work.

I came upon a convenience store and planted myself on the apron. Just as I was about to begin dissecting the phone, I heard someone ask, "Adam?". It was Joe²¹⁷, a guy I met at the shelter. He didn't live there, but he would visit occasionally for lunch. Joe also happened to be a former tech guy (ex-Google) in much the same situation as I. He offered to give me a ride to a cellular phone store.²¹⁸

After arriving at the store, I figured I might as well let them change the battery. Except they didn't service phones there. So I tried it myself. Despite having

the beginning of this book.

²¹⁴ Apparently demons are contagious!

²¹⁵ This being the laptop that contained the only copy of the unpublished manuscript of the book you're holding in your hands.

²¹⁶ I actually managed to recover it from the burned phone and it appeared to be undamaged.

²¹⁷ Yeah, his name is really Joe. Why would I start using pseudonyms now?

²¹⁸ It was AT&T. But I wasn't scared because I have enough experience communicating with demons to know how to handle the situation.

changed phone batteries on many other occasions, the particular model of this phone was quite hostile to battery replacements. Realizing that paying someone else to do this replacement would be cheaper than getting a new phone if I fumbled this, I decided to seek out a phone repair place.

As luck would have it, there was one just a short walk away. So, off I went. The repair tech said it would cost \$50 just for the labor to do the battery replacement. Still being cheaper than replacing the phone and believing that I had more than enough money in my bank account²¹⁹ to cover the expense, I agreed.

After completing the replacement, the phone booted right up for the first time. I explained that I had the money to pay for the repair, but accessing that money was contingent on the phone working.²²⁰ Using their wifi, I was able to access my notes where I keep records of *everything*, including all of my banking information, debit card number, etc. So, using manual entry on the credit card machine, I recited the numbers of my debit card to her. \$41 cleared.²²¹ I explained that was all I had and started counting the change in my pocket. She said, “Don’t worry, I’ll pay it myself. Just get back on your feet.” I thanked her repeatedly and left with the phone²²².

I then hoofed it back to the cellular phone store where a large Samoan man activated service and required no payment²²³ for doing so.

²¹⁹ Remember, my debit cards burned. But I had a plan, albeit a plan with zero margin for error...

²²⁰ Of course, my old SIM card did not work.

²²¹ I should have had at least \$250. Obviously, some bill had come through and drafted the account automatically. How convenient...

²²² I have since returned and repaid the \$15. She was so surprised! She really never expected me to return. The guy who gave me a ride there noted, “This is why things always turn out so well for you.” I’m not sure if “not dying” = “so well”, but I appreciated the sentiment. Nonetheless, I would do the same thing even if I had certain knowledge of my own death occurring only minutes later.

²²³ This wasn’t an act of compassion. You should have seen the size of the bill they sent me... it required it’s own mail truck to deliver it!

After that, there was little I could do but wait for Joe to return from his day running errands for other people. Now armed with a fully functioning phone, I realized that my favorite Vietnamese restaurant, Lab C Food Kitchen²²⁴, was nearby²²⁵. But then I remembered that I was flat broke. Well... not exactly. Checking my pockets, I had exactly 60 cents.

Fuck it.

I walked in the door and plunked my 60 cents on the counter and asked, “What can I get with this?”²²⁶ The attractive young woman behind the counter barely paused and then said, “Let me check.”²²⁷ She walked to the back and conferred with a man I knew to be the owner from a previous visit and then put in an order with the kitchen. A short while later, she handed me a bag full of food! I thanked her and the owner profusely and took a seat at a picnic table out front.

After eating, I laid back on the bench and just watched the sky. After some time, my meditation was broken by, “Excuse me, sir, are you okay?” I rose like a vampire from his coffin. The speaker was an attractive woman in her late thirties who was now seated on the opposite bench. “Why yes, I’m just waiting on a friend to give me a ride.”

She was having none of it. Ten minutes later, I found myself recounting the

²²⁴ I am aware that you have questions. But this time, I have no answers to offer. Just accept it.

²²⁵ I am also aware that you can now pinpoint the exact location where this story takes place. While you’re in Google Maps, you can use street view to even see the exact bench I sat on!

²²⁶ Remember, I still had my laptop slung over one shoulder and my clothes & toiletries in a large bag over the other, so despite being well-dressed and rather put together personally, the story was quite easy to read.

²²⁷ I’m dropping the proper conversational format at this point for the sake of not making this story twice as long as it has to be.

very tale I'm telling you right now. At that point, she was holding my hands and staring deeply into my eyes. Then she asked, "Do you mind if I pray for you?" To be honest, that wasn't among the top five activities I would have been agreeable to in that moment, but it was somewhere on the list. "Sure."

She's done this before.

She started off with a prayer, then it turned into something more akin to a blessing ceremony... then she went into full-on exorcism mode! I found this intensely amusing because I literally had nothing better to do and I absolutely adore absurdity! I mean, she's going full exorcist mode right in front of a Goodwill!

Despite the absurdity, I also couldn't help but appreciate how erotic²²⁸ this all was. Meanwhile, passersby were horrified²²⁹, which was both hilarious and added to the surreal quality of the scene.

After that production had run its course, she asked, "What do you need?" I replied, "The good news is that I have no problems that money cannot solve."²³⁰ We exchanged contact information²³¹ and she promised to text me later.

True to her word, a couple of hours later, I received a text, "Where are you?" "Same place you left me." "OK, I'm leaving Walmart now." A few minutes later, she arrived bearing gifts: a tent, a sleeping bag, thick blankets, pillows, and even a space heater. It was immediately evident that this human genuinely

²²⁸ I understand that not everyone finds the idea of being exorcised erotic. So I just wanted to point out that you are 100% entitled to be wrong.

²²⁹ I gathered that the other Goodwill patrons were under the impression that the space we were occupying was intended for some activity other than exorcisms. Weird.

²³⁰ This is not actually a sarcastic comment. Most people in my position have mental illness, substance abuse issues, or other social issues compounding their predicaments. So being able to solve all of one's problems with money actually makes things dramatically simpler.

²³¹ Since I'm doxxing everyone anyway, her name is Brittany.

cared²³² whether or not I survived the night. In that moment, she was one of a small handful of people I could say that about.

She noted, “With your other bags, there’s no way that you can possibly carry all of that!” “It’s fine, Joe will show up eventually.” “Do you know where you’re going to sleep tonight?” “That hasn’t revealed itself yet”, I said nonchalantly as the sun was setting behind me, “...but it will.”

Sure enough, Joe arrived and we loaded up the stuff into his car. “I’m sorry I’m so late, I had...” “It’s fine. I needed that time to get all of these supplies to survive the night.” “But how?” I recounted the story to him. With a flabbergasted look on his face, he remarked, “That’s incredible. I was so worried how that was going to work out.”

Joe continued, “But I have more good news, my friend Ray has agreed to meet with you about setting up camp on his land²³³. That way, you don’t have to worry about anyone messing with you or stealing your stuff.²³⁴” Joe dropped me off at Ray’s place and he and I got along great. Ray is interested in various brands of alternative spirituality, so it was a breath of fresh air after having been immersed in pastor Nava’s small-minded wonderland²³⁵. Ray ended up offering me the master bedroom²³⁶ and volunteered to take the living room sofa for himself.

Ray is a house painter. So the next day, I prepared for my first day as an assistant house painter. The job paid \$15/hr, which was considerably better

²³² If that doesn’t seem extraordinary to you, then you have lived a blessed life.

²³³ Ray owns ±5 acres outside of town, upon which sits two dilapidated trailers. But still, “dilapidated trailer” > “tent”.

²³⁴ That statement was half correct.

²³⁵ Which had been just that same morning, BTW. All of this happened in just one day!

²³⁶ This sounds much more gracious than it is. There is no electricity in the half of the trailer where the master bedroom is. Sleeping on the couch afforded him not only a heater, but the ability to monitor the only door...

than the \$0/hr that the good pastor paid for back-breaking physical labor. We were performing restoration work on a 100+ year old house. For those of you fortunate enough to never have to do such work, it involves manually scraping off the old paint from 100-year-old wooden siding (slats), replacing the rotten slats, sanding every slat smooth, then priming, and applying two coats²³⁷ of paint to the entire house. In summary: It sucks!

The depressing thing about the situation was that unlike pastor Nava's, there were no free meals. So we would work 5 hours just to make enough money to afford to eat and pay bills. That's it. Let me tell you, that's depressing as hell! It strips any semblance of hope right out of your mind and leaves you in a state of desolate slavery. That's why I really don't blame Ray for acting the way he does. Any sane person has to have an escape from that reality or else they're going to opt for the permanent escape.

Every day after work, Ray and I would stop by the convenience store to buy the night's beer: 32oz or what are you even trying to do? On special occasions, there was a certain \$10 bottle of whiskey he was fond of. I was not fond of special occasions. Ray was an angry drunk and would frequently get belligerent about the most asinine things imaginable. Conveniently, he would have no memory of it the next morning.

By now, you know how much I like to share every detail of everything. But I think in this case, there's really no need to. You know damned good and well how this situation turned out.

I'm writing this to you now from a domestic violence shelter in an undisclosed location. It's just me and 20 or so women who have been through some shit. I feel completely within my element. I'll take being surrounded by people who have been dragged through the mud over young millionaires any day of the week. But one important thing to note here about being me among injured people: I'm not here to help them. I'm here to do what I would be doing if I were elsewhere. I have no agenda nor desire to "heal" these women, nor do I offer them a single word if they do not request it. All I offer is presence. If they

²³⁷ You may be able to get away with one coat where you live, but this is Texas!

want anything more than that, they can ask and I will probably give them what they request, but nothing more.²³⁸

I wish I could say that I'm finally safe, but I'm absolutely not. Not only are there active threats of physical violence present in the shelter that are tolerated for reasons I cannot fathom, but I had a repeat of my experience with pastor Nava also.

On Christmas Eve, the shelter served us a lovely catered dinner. Unfortunately, whoever catered it did not observe safe food handling practices and many people became very ill from the food, but I got it the worst. Suffice it to say that messes were made over the course of many hours. After managing to get about 2 hours of sleep, a staff member who I will simply refer to as Satan, woke me up to inform me that I had to clean up the mess right then or I could find somewhere else to live. So much for being a safe space to heal.

Feeling that I had no choice, I attempted to comply. This was not a good choice, medically, but the only choice strategically. The pain came back intensely and I yelled for the office to call an ambulance. Satan wouldn't have done it because that move now makes her insistence on me cleaning look *very* bad. Fortunately for me, her shift had ended and Zoe, a kind, trauma-informed human, was on the current shift. So once again, I was whisked away in an ambulance and this time treated for food poisoning.²³⁹

Fortunately, Satan doesn't get to decide my fate today, so I survive for a while longer yet. But knowing how tenuous my residency here is, I'm taking advantage of every possible moment to get this book to print as fast as possible.

²³⁸ When an initiate is early in their journey and having gnoses left and right, they become so annoyingly excited about it all that they want to share those gnoses with everyone they come in contact with, unaware that other people are unprepared to hear what is being communicated, so it comes across as unhinged rambling. I spend all of my time writing this book, yet only one of the women here has any idea what I'm doing... and even her understanding is very vague.

²³⁹ I was treated for the flu last time if you didn't catch that detail.

Therefore, I beg your forgiveness for any rough edges, errors, or other unsightly mistakes you may have found on your journey through these pages. I hope that they did not obscure the ideas I have tried to present and that you have benefited from the experience of sharing this mind space with me.